

🌐 Quantifiers & Food Cooking and Recipes

A Pre-A1 English Lesson — English For Comorians

Level: Pre-A1 (Beginner)

Topic: a lot of, a few, a little, too much / too many

Characters: Ahmed and his mother, Ahmed and Yusuf

1. New Words (Vocabulary)

Food (Countable — we can count)

TomatoesOnionsEggsPotatoesBananasApples

Food (Uncountable — we cannot count)

RiceSugarSaltOilWaterFlourMilk

Cooking Words

CookCutBoilMixAddPotPanSpoonKitchen

2. Grammar — Quantifiers

Quantifier	Use	Example
a lot of	countable & uncountable — a big amount	There is a lot of rice. There are a lot of tomatoes.
a few	countable — a small number	There are a few eggs.
a little	uncountable — a small amount	There is a little salt.
too many	countable — more than we need (negative)	There are too many onions!
too much	uncountable — more than we need (negative)	There is too much sugar!

Rule: **Countable** nouns (we can count them: 1, 2, 3) use **a few / too many**. **Uncountable** nouns (we cannot count them) use **a little / too much**. Both use **a lot of**.

Countable	Uncountable
tomatoes, onions, eggs, potatoes, bananas, apples	rice, sugar, salt, oil, water, flour, milk

3. Dialog 1 — In the Kitchen

Ahmed: Mom, what is in the kitchen today?

Mother: There is a lot of rice, and there are a few tomatoes.

Ahmed: Is there a lot of oil?

Mother: No, there is only a little oil.

Ahmed: Can I help you cook?

Mother: Yes! Please cut a few onions for me.

Ahmed: Ok! How many onions?

Mother: Just a few. Not too many!

4. Dialog 2 — Cooking is Difficult

Ahmed: Yusuf, I am cooking rice today!

Yusuf: Nice! How much rice do you have?

Ahmed: I have a lot of rice, but only a little water.

Yusuf: You need more water! And how much salt?

Ahmed: Oh no, I put too much salt!

Yusuf: Ha ha! And too many onions too?

Ahmed: Yes... too many onions. My food is not good today. ☹️

Yusuf: Don't worry, Ahmed! Cooking is difficult. Try again tomorrow.

5. Reading Text — My Mother's Kitchen

My mother cooks every day. She is a good cook.

In our kitchen, there is a lot of rice and a lot of flour.

There are a few eggs and a few potatoes.

There is only a little sugar, so my mother buys more sugar at the market.

My mother says, "Don't put too much salt in the food!"

She cuts the tomatoes and the onions. She adds a little oil to the pan.

Then she mixes the food and boils the rice.

I like my mother's food. It is always delicious!

6. Recipe — Simple Tomato Rice

 **Simple Tomato Rice**

Ingredients: a lot of rice, a few tomatoes, a few onions, a little oil, a little salt, water

Steps:

1. Cut a few tomatoes and a few onions.
2. Add a little oil to the pot.
3. Add the tomatoes and onions. Mix well.
4. Add a lot of rice and water.
5. Add a little salt. Do not add too much salt!
6. Boil the rice for 20 minutes.
7. Enjoy your food! 😊

7. Exercises

Exercise A — a few or a little?

1. There is _____ salt in the food.
2. There are _____ eggs in the kitchen.
3. I have _____ sugar for tea.
4. She has _____ apples in her bag.
5. There is _____ oil in the pan.
6. There are _____ potatoes on the table.

Exercise B — too much or too many?

1. There is _____ salt in this food. It is not good.
2. There are _____ onions in the pot!
3. He put _____ sugar in the tea.
4. There are _____ tomatoes in the bag.
5. There is _____ water in the rice.

Exercise C — Countable or Uncountable? Write C or U

1. Rice	_____	4. Tomatoes	_____
2. Eggs	_____	5. Oil	_____
3. Sugar	_____	6. Potatoes	_____

Exercise D — Choose the correct quantifier

1. There is (a lot of / a few) rice in the kitchen.
2. She has (a little / too many) money.
3. There are (a lot of / too much) tomatoes in the market.

4. He has (a few / a little) friends.
5. Don't add (too much / too many) salt!

Exercise E — True or False (about the reading text)

1. My mother cooks every day. (True / False)
2. There is a lot of sugar in the kitchen. (True / False)
3. There are a few eggs. (True / False)
4. My mother adds a lot of oil. (True / False)
5. The food is delicious. (True / False)

Exercise F — Write your own recipe

Write a simple recipe. Use quantifiers (a lot of, a few, a little, too much/too many).

Name of the dish: _____

Ingredients: _____

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Exercise G — Speaking practice (with a partner)

1. What food do you like to cook?
2. Do you put a lot of salt in your food?
3. How many eggs do you eat every week?
4. Is there a lot of rice in your kitchen?
5. Do you like cooking? Why or why not?

Answer Key

Exercise A: 1. a little 2. a few 3. a little 4. a few 5. a little 6. a few

Exercise B: 1. too much 2. too many 3. too much 4. too many 5. too much

Exercise C: 1. U 2. C 3. U 4. C 5. U 6. C

Exercise D: 1. a lot of 2. a little 3. a lot of 4. a few 5. too much

Exercise E: 1. True 2. False 3. True 4. False 5. True

Exercise F & G: Free answers — check students' own sentences.